and makes it an excuse for withholding from us even the outer forms of political freedom. The Indian Princes, strangely enough, make this a justification for their unchecked autocracy and stoutly declare their intention of maintaining medieval conditions in their domains such as exist nowhere else in the world.[1] But the failure of parliamentary democracy is not that it has gone too far, but that it did not go far enough. It was not democratic enough because it did not provide for economic democracy, and its methods were slow and cumbrous and unsuited to a period of rapid change.

The Indian States represent to-day probably the extremest type of autocracy existing in the world. They are, of course, subject to British suzerainty, but the British Government interferes only for the protection or advancement of British interests. It is really astonishing how these feudal old-world *enclaves* have carried on with so little change right into the middle of the twentieth century. The air is heavy and still there, and the waters move sluggishly, and the newcomer, used to change and movement and a little weary of them perhaps, feels a drowsiness, and a faint charm steals over him. It all seems unreal, like a picture where time stands still and an unchanging scene meets

[1] The Maharaja of Patiala, Chancellor of the Chamber of Princes, speaking in the Chamber at Delhi on January 22nd, 1935, referred to the opinion of Indian politicians who favour Federation in the hope that the Princes would be forced by circumstances to introduce democratic forms of government. He went on to say that "while the Princes of India have always been willing to do what was best for their people, and will be ready to accommodate themselves and their constitutions to the spirit of the times, we must frankly say that if British India is hoping to compel us to wear on our healthy body politic the Nessus shirt of a discredited political theory, they are living in a world of unreality." (See also p. 501 *ante* for Mysore Dewan's speech.) Speaking on the same day in the Chamber of Princes, the Maharaja of Bikaner said: "We, the Rulers of the Indian States, are not soldiers of fortune. And I take the liberty of stating that we who, through centuries of heredity, can claim to have inherited the instincts of rule and, I trust, a certain measure of statesmanship, should take the utmost care to safeguard against our being stampeded in a hurry to any hasty or ill-considered decision. . . May I in all modesty say that the Princes have no intention of allowing themselves to be destroyed by anybody, and that should the time unfortunately come when the Crown is unable to afford the Indian States the necessary protection in fulfilment of its treaty obligations, the Princes and States will die fighting to the bitter end."